

• The Chromecast

The OG streaming stick, the Chromecast was released on July 24th, 2013 alongside the unveiling of Google Cast. It was a small dongle with HDMI built into the chassis itself. It retailed for about \$35 (₹2,799) and contained a Marvell Armada 1500-mini 88DE3005 SoC (with a Cortex A9 processor) which supported hardware decoding of the VP8 and H.264 video compression formats, allowing for fast, high quality streams. It was very well received and sold out within 24 hours of launch on all major resellers (Perhaps helped by the 90 days of Free Netflix that Google threw in at the time with every purchase to sweeten the deal). It received generally positive reviews from critics and was a very successful product.



OG Chromecast

Two years later on September 29th, 2015, Google released an updated version of the Chromecast. The second generation ditched the all in one dongle form factor of the original, and instead was a disk with a short length of HDMI cable extending from it. This change was presumably to keep the processor cooler,

which also got an upgrade this time around, packing a Marvell Armada 1500 Mini Plus 88DE3006 SoC with a pair of Cortex A7 processors. The cable was flexible and was able to attach to the circular disk of the Chromecast using magnets, allowing for better positioning behind the screen.

• The Chromecast Audio

The Chromecast Audio was launched alongside the second generation Chromecast. It looked similar, in that it was a circular disc with a wire extending out. But instead of HDMI, this wire was an AUX cord, which you could plug into any speaker with a 3.5mm jack (which is most of them) to make it Chromecast ready. It also retailed for \$35 (₹2,799), even though all it could cast was audio. There was more attention paid to visual detail on the Chromecast Audio, with a bright yellow detachable AUX wire and circular engraving on the main disc, reminiscent of the whorls of a record. It combined a TOSLINK port with the 3.5 mm jack to ensure that even if